

The 6:15

MONDAY · AUGUST 31, 2026

NO. 9

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Mon 8/31	No major US data; markets reacting to Sunday's Iran-Jordan exchange (see Lead)
Tue 9/1	ISM Manufacturing PMI, 10:00a (July: 55.6%); Dell FQ2 earnings; Palo Alto Networks after close (cons. \$3.35B rev, \$0.98 EPS)
Wed 9/2	Broadcom earnings after close (cons. \$29.43B rev, \$2.55 GAAP EPS)
Thu 9/3	Weekly jobless claims, 8:30a
Fri 9/4	Aug. jobs report, 8:30a (BLS) — cons. +110K vs. July's +73K, unemployment 4.2% (FactSet)
Sat 9/5	Northwestern opener vs. South Dakota State, 7:00p CT
Mon 9/7	Labor Day, markets closed
Tue 9/8	Canada's dollar-for-dollar tariffs on ~\$27.6B of U.S. imports take effect
Wed 9/9	South Dakota state primary
Fri 9/11	Aug. CPI, 8:30a
Wed 9/16	FOMC decision — Sept. hike odds 57-59% (CME FedWatch) as of Friday

No verified political primary beyond South Dakota, rocket launch, frontier AI model release, or major VC round fell in this window this run (Starship's next flight is dated 9/30; New Glenn remains grounded since May's pad explosion).

METRICS · TIMES ET UNLESS NOTED

Oil	ICE Brent \$90.5-90.7/bbl early Mon trade (+2.7-2.9%, trackers vary, no settle yet) [flag] ; NYMEX WTI \$85.0-86.0/bbl (+~2.5%, no settle) [flag] ; spread ~\$5
Rates	2Y 4.36% (Fri close), 10Y 4.72% (steady Mon), 30Y 5.21% (Fri close, stale) [flag] . DXY 99.65 (Sun, -0.05%)

Equities	S&P fut. -0.1% to -0.27%; Nasdaq 100 fut. flat to -0.23%; VIX fut. 17.3 (vs. Fri spot 14.43)
Gold	Sources disagree sharply: \$4,459/oz vs. \$4,604/oz — no reconciled print [flag]
Asia/Europe	Nikkei -0.14%, Hang Seng flat, Kospi +0.46%, CSI 300 +0.35% (Mon close). Stoxx 600 just below flat, energy outperforming [flag: session open]
Retail gas	\$4.08/gal natl. avg (AAA, 8/31, -2¢ w/w) — priciest August on record pace

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 183 (straits.live, as of 8/31)
Escalation	US struck 2 IRGC launchers on Larak Island Sun (CENTCOM), first direct strike in >1 month; Iran retaliated on 2 US bases in Jordan, nearly all intercepted (see Lead)
Strikes, 24h	UKMTO 122-26: unidentified projectile struck inbound tanker ~12nm N of Khasab, Oman, ~2053Z Sat; unattributed
Running total	≥70 ships attacked, 19 seafarers killed since 2/28 (UKMTO-linked) — separate measure from trackers below
Transits	PortWatch (8/23): 3/day vs. 85/day baseline (4%) [stale] . Kpler (wk 8/17-23): 7 transits, none VLCC/LNG
Dark tankers	88 AIS-dark/24h vs. 7-day avg 52.7 (straits.live) [flag: sample differs from last issue]
War-risk premium	~\$10.0M/VLCC transit, ~40x pre-crisis (straits.live); trade press: 7.5-10% of hull value. Crisis-pressure index: 90/100

Methodology, unchanged: Kpler's near-real-time AIS counts, Lloyd's List's slower weekly aggregation, and PortWatch's baseline snapshots measure different things over different windows — never netted or averaged against each other.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Swept Red Sox (L 0-6, W 9-2, W 16-1). 78-59, AL's No. 1 Wild Card, 4 GB Tampa Bay
Knicks	Hart finalizing 4-yr/\$81M extension per agents [NEW]
Northwestern	No new moves; opens Sat 9/5 vs. South Dakota State

First direct US-Iran exchange in a month reopens the oil-shock question Friday's Fed speech never had to answer

US Central Command said Sunday its forces struck two Iranian rocket launchers on Larak Island, inside the Strait of Hormuz, after observing IRGC personnel "preparing to launch rockets with sea mines into the Strait" — in the words of CENTCOM spokesman Capt. Tim Hawkins — marking the first publicly acknowledged direct US strike on Iranian positions in more than a month. Iran's Revolutionary Guards said the strike killed and wounded "several" fighters and civilians, without giving a toll, and vowed to "punish those responsible"; CENTCOM separately rejected the IRGC's framing of the episode as an "act of aggression," calling its own action "limited, precise" and aimed at an imminent minelaying threat to commercial shipping. Iran responded within hours, firing ballistic and anti-ship missiles from Tehran, Lorestan, Karaj, Khorramabad and Shiraz, plus drones, at two US installations in Jordan — King Hussein Air Base and Al-Azraq Air Base, according to Iranian state media. A US official said nearly all incoming projectiles were intercepted, with no significant impact reported as of press time. [NEW]

Oil moved first and hardest. Brent's front-month contract, trading in the high \$80s through Friday, jumped to roughly \$90.5-90.7/bbl in early Monday trade (+2.7-2.9%; trackers disagree on the exact print and there is no clean settle this early), while WTI rose into the mid-\$80s (+~2.5%). Equity futures reversed the "quiet 24 hours" framing this issue had been tracking as recently as Saturday: S&P

500 futures fell as much as 0.27% and Nasdaq 100 futures 0.23% in the immediate aftermath, though both had pared losses to roughly flat-to-down-0.1% by the New York premarket as the intercepted-with-no-impact read settled in. VIX futures, at 17.3, sit well above Friday's 14.43 spot close — a volatility bid spot hadn't caught up to as of writing. Asia closed mixed (Nikkei -0.14%, Hang Seng flat), and Europe's Stoxx 600 traded just below flat with energy shares outperforming on the oil move.

The timing compounds Friday's other story. Fed Chair Warsh used his Jackson Hole keynote to argue inflation, not employment, is the Fed's "predominant" concern, and traders responded by pushing September hike odds to 57-59% from 35% Thursday — a hawkish repricing built on an assumption of resilient growth and domestically driven price pressure. [continuity from Saturday's issue] An oil shock complicates that framework from both directions at once: higher energy costs feed straight into the same inflation prints Warsh flagged as the binding constraint, while a serious Hormuz disruption is also a demand shock to a global economy the Fed is simultaneously trying to cool. [read: this is the first live test of whether Warsh's Fed treats an oil-driven inflation impulse the same as a demand-driven one — a hawkish chair who hikes into a geopolitical supply shock risks being read as fighting the wrong problem, while standing pat looks like exactly the discretionary, data-dependent approach he spent Friday defending.] Nothing so far suggests a repeat of February's initial closure at scale — the exchange looks contained to a single strike-and-retaliate cycle with no reported US casualties — but markets spent five months pricing a slow bleed in Hormuz throughput, not a fresh military exchange, and Monday's session is still working out which regime it's in.

The exchange also ends the lull flagged Saturday, which had already been complicated by a separate UK Maritime Trade Operations warning: a crude tanker was struck by an unidentified projectile roughly 12 nautical miles north of Khasab, Oman, late Saturday evening — an incident distinct from the Larak Island exchange and still unattributed. [NEW] Whether Tehran treats Sunday's exchange as closed or opens a new response window is what the oil market will spend Monday pricing; CENTCOM's statement gave no indication of further planned US action, and no third-country diplomatic channel was reported active as of this writing.

BUSINESS

Wall Street's next test of the AI-capex trade that broadened last week — Nvidia's \$108B Q3 guide, Marvell's \$3.15B guide — arrives via two more prints: Palo Alto Networks reports Tuesday after the close (LSEG consensus \$3.35B revenue, \$0.98 EPS), and Broadcom reports Wednesday after the close (consensus \$29.43B revenue, \$2.55 GAAP EPS) — its first read on whether hyperscaler ordering strength holds up in a week that opened with an oil shock rather than a clean macro backdrop. [NEW] Dell Technologies also reports fiscal Q2 results Tuesday. CNBC's trading-desk preview flagged cybersecurity spending as this week's second theme, following CrowdStrike's beat-and-raise the prior Wednesday — Palo Alto's print is now read as a referendum on whether that strength is company-specific or sector-wide. [read] None of the three has reported as of this writing; treat the consensus figures above as previews, not results. One trade estimate puts Broadcom's AI-infrastructure order backlog at roughly \$60 billion heading into Wednesday's print **[flag: single-sourced trade estimate, not a company disclosure]** — if anywhere close to accurate, it would

frame Wednesday's guidance as the more market-moving number than the quarter just reported, continuing the pattern set by Nvidia and Marvell.

GEOPOLITICS

A Russian strike on a warehouse in Myla, west of Kyiv, late Friday has become one of the war's deadliest single attacks this year: the death toll reached 38 by Sunday, with four still missing and at least 42 injured, President Zelenskyy said, after secondary explosions and fire tore through roughly 130 nearby residential buildings and a retirement home. [NEW] Ukrainian officials said the warehouse was storing ammunition. Casualties continued through the weekend beyond that single strike — a Saturday attack on Kyiv killed a 2-year-old girl and injured 12 others, and Russian bombs killed a 13-year-old and an adult in Bilbasovka in eastern Ukraine on Sunday — while Kyiv endured a third consecutive night of drone attacks and air-raid alerts into Aug. 30. [fact]

Ukraine's own economic-infrastructure campaign continued in parallel: it struck Russia's KINEF refinery in Leningrad Oblast overnight Saturday — at least the sixth reported Ukrainian attack on the facility, Russia's second-largest — plus a drone-launch site and an airbase in Krasnodar Krai. [NEW] Both sides remain focused on fuel, logistics and now, with Friday's warehouse strike, dense civilian infrastructure — a scale-up from the pattern flagged in Saturday's issue. No new diplomatic channel or ceasefire framework was reported active this run, and Xi's Sept. 24 Washington summit remains on the calendar with export controls still unresolved.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond Sunday's military exchange (see Lead), the strait's ship-attack tally moved separately: UKMTO's Warning 122-26 reported a crude tanker struck by an unknown projectile approximately 12

nautical miles north of Khasab, Oman, while transiting inbound, at roughly 2053 UTC Saturday — no casualties or pollution reported, vessel identity and attribution undisclosed as of this writing. [NEW] That ends the clean 24-hour quiet window flagged in Saturday's issue, though the Aug. 24 Metro Venetian strike off Ash Shishah, Oman remains unattributed nine days on; JMIC's most recent update (Aug. 25) documented continued IRGC harassment short of a confirmed strike claim, and nothing fresher on that specific incident surfaced this run. [continuity] By one UKMTO-linked count, at least 70 ships have now been attacked and 19 seafarers killed in the strait since the crisis began Feb. 28 — a running total that measures something different from the daily trackers below and shouldn't be netted against them.

Transit data still splits by vendor and remains stale on the fastest-moving series: PortWatch's latest snapshot (Aug. 23) puts throughput at 3 vessels a day against an 85-per-day pre-crisis baseline — 4% of normal — while Kpler's most recent weekly count (Aug. 17-23) recorded just seven transits, none of them VLCCs or LNG carriers, characterizing overall flow at roughly 40% of 2025 levels on its own methodology. **[flag: no fresher PortWatch or Lloyd's List figure than the last issue]** Straits.live's dark-tanker screen found 88 vessels showing AIS gaps in the past 24 hours against a 7-day baseline of 52.7 — both figures drawn from a different, larger screened population than Saturday's 240-vessel sample, so the totals aren't directly comparable across issues. The same tracker holds its VLCC war-risk premium estimate at roughly \$10 million per transit, about 40x pre-crisis levels, and puts its crisis-pressure index at 90 of 100 ("extreme") — broadly consistent with trade-press estimates (Lloyd's List, Howden Re) pegging current Hormuz war-risk premiums at

7.5-10% of hull value, up from 1-3% just weeks ago, though the two sources frame the number differently (dollar figure vs. percentage of hull value) and shouldn't be combined. [read: Sunday's exchange happened without moving the war-risk premium off levels that already reflected five months of closure — insurers had priced something close to worst-case before this weekend.] No fresher status on the still-detained tanker Amara near Qeshm Island was located this run; its hold past Aug. 21 remains unconfirmed.

The volume picture underneath the transit counts: Gulf crude exports are running at roughly 9 million bpd as of August, down 47% from 2025's ~17 million bpd, with Kpler putting direct through-strait flow at just 2.2 million bpd (Al Jazeera, Aug. 27, citing Kpler). [continuity] That coexists with a less-intuitive data point from the same week — Bloomberg reported Aug. 27 that Gulf producers have been raising overall exports despite the security risk, implying more volume is now moving around the strait (via Saudi and UAE pipeline capacity to the Red Sea and Fujairah) rather than through it. [read: the throughput collapse in the daily transit counts above measures the strait specifically, not total Gulf supply reaching the market — the two data points aren't in conflict, but reading only the transit counts overstates how much physical barrel supply has actually been lost.]

SPORTS

Yankees	Swept Red Sox (L 0-6, W 9-2, W 16-1). 78-59, AL's No. 1 Wild Card, 4 GB Tampa Bay.
Knicks	Off-season. Hart finalizing 4-yr/\$81M extension — resolves the unsigned thread carried since 8/17.
Northwestern	Off-season. Opens Sat 9/5, 7:00p CT vs. South Dakota State — unchanged since 8/26; Ryan Field debuts 10/2 vs.

Penn State.

Continuity. Dropped as unchanged since 8/29: the Cook/White House letter exchange (no WH response yet), Anthropic's still-unfiled public S-1, the Khamenei/IRGC command reshuffle, the House-Senate funding gap, Metro Venetian attribution, Amara's status. Watch: whether Iran treats Sunday's exchange as closed or escalates further; Tue/Wed's actual PANW, Dell and Broadcom results; Tuesday's ISM print and Friday's actual jobs report; a fresher Hormuz transit count; attribution on the Khasab-area strike and Metro Venetian; Canada's 9/8 tariff date and the 9/16 FOMC decision.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.